

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 11, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 38:14-23

14 "Therefore, son of man, prophesy and say to Gog, 'Thus says the Lord God: "On that day when My people Israel dwell safely, will you not know it?"

15 Then you will come from your place out of the far north, you and many peoples with you, all of them riding on horses, a great company and a mighty army.

16 You will come up against My people Israel like a cloud, to cover the land. It will be in the latter days that I will bring you against My land, so that the nations may know Me, when I am hallowed in you, O Gog, before their eyes."

17 Thus says the Lord God: "Are you he of whom I have spoken in former days by My servants the prophets of Israel, who prophesied for years in those days that I would bring you against them?"

18 "And it will come to pass at the same time, when Gog comes against the land of Israel," says the Lord God, "that My fury will show in My face.

19 For in My jealousy and in the fire of My wrath I have spoken: 'Surely in that day there shall be a great earthquake in the land of Israel,

20 so that the fish of the sea, the birds of the heavens, the beasts of the field, all creeping things that creep on the earth, and all men who are on the face of the earth shall shake at My presence. The mountains shall be thrown down, the steep places shall fall, and every wall shall fall to the ground.'

21 I will call for a sword against Gog throughout all My mountains," says the Lord God. "Every man's sword will be against his brother.

22 And I will bring him to judgment with pestilence and bloodshed; I will rain down on him, on his troops, and on the many peoples who are with him, flooding rain, great hailstones, fire, and brimstone.

23 Thus I will magnify Myself and sanctify Myself, and I will be known in the eyes of many

nations. Then they shall know that I am the Lord."

II. Key Summary

- God tells Ezekiel to prophesy to Gog: on the day when Israel is dwelling safely, Gog will come from the far north with many peoples, a great company and a mighty army, covering the land like a cloud (vv. 14-16).
 - God says this will happen in the latter days, and that He Himself will "bring you against My land" — the very thing He had spoken years before through His servants the prophets of Israel (vv. 16-17).
 - When Gog comes, God's fury is unleashed: a great earthquake in Israel, fish, birds and all people shaking, mountains thrown down and every wall falling; God judges Gog with the sword, pestilence, flooding rain, hailstones, fire and brimstone, and declares He will magnify and sanctify Himself so that many nations will know He is the Lord (vv. 18-23).
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III. Passage Analysis

When the force comes crashing in, God is still the one in control

God deliberately pulled Gog and his allies to come against Israel. At the same time, Gog was prompted by his own evil plan, by the thoughts in his own mind. Yahweh did not drag an unwilling Gog to come against Israel. [1]

Two things are true at once in this passage: Gog chose to invade out of his own greed, and God says "I will bring you against My land." So the power that looks completely out of control — huge and terrifying — never for a moment slips outside God's hand.

The whole thing ends at "then they shall know that I am the Lord"

In the destruction of sinners God makes it to appear that he is a great and holy God, and he will do so to eternity. And, if men do not magnify and sanctify him as they ought, he will magnify himself, and sanctify himself. [2]

Verse 23 is the conclusion of the whole section: the earthquake, the sword, the hailstones and brimstone are not there to frighten people for its own sake — they point to one

purpose, that many nations would actually come to know who God is. God does not need anyone to defend His reputation; He makes Himself known.

IV. Reflection Question

What is something in your life right now that you can't control no matter how hard you try, something that makes you tense just thinking about it?

In Ezekiel 38, even that army from the far north — so vast it covered the land like a cloud — is the one God says "I will bring you against My land." Nothing is outside His control.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Ezekiel 38,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-38/>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary on Ezekiel 38,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/Eze/Eze_038.cfm